INDIA CREDIT LENS · **SEP 2026 · PRIVATE BANKS**

Private banks' card spending almost stopped growing

72.7% of card value at shops

but

+1.4% growth in a year

The market grew 7.2%. Inside that 1.4% are four very different stories.

In a month, their yearly growth went from 4.2% to 1.4%.

RBI ATM, POS and card statistics · 7 slides

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THE PUZZLE · CARD VALUE AT SHOPS

So how are some of them growing 40%?

BANK	SHARE	YOY	STORY
All private	**72.7%**	**1.4%**	
HDFC Bank	26.5%	−6.7%	Giant
ICICI Bank	11.4%	−9.2%	Giant
Axis Bank	15.5%	15.7%	Still moving
Yes Bank	3.6%	41.6%	Challenger
Federal Bank	1.5%	40.7%	Challenger
Kotak	4.3%	35.8%	Challenger
IDFC First	3.7%	26.8%	Challenger
IndusInd	2.2%	−42.8%	Falling behind
RBL Bank	3.2%	3.9%	Falling behind

YoY = against the same month last year. Share = of all banks.

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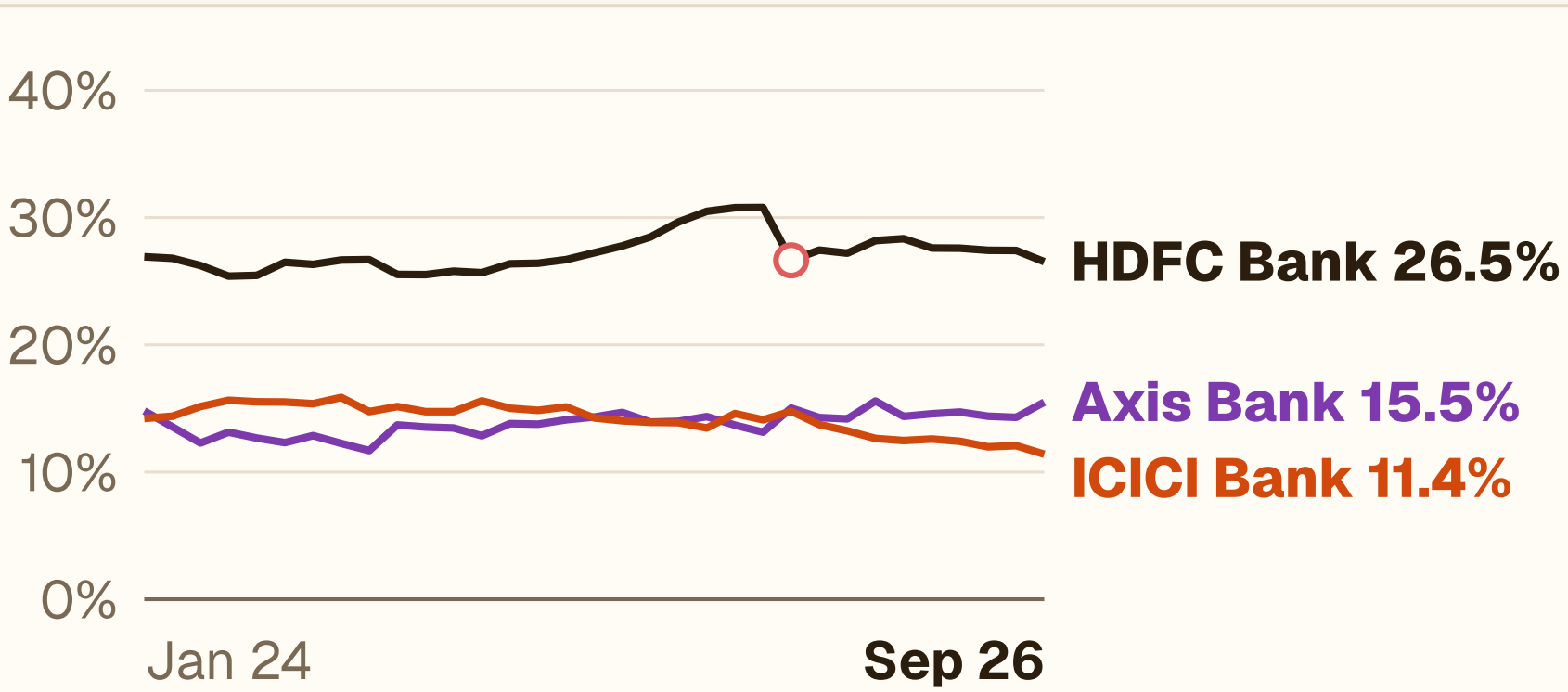
1 · THE GIANTS

HDFC and ICICI go backwards

–6.7% and **–9.2%**

HDFC Bank — ICICI Bank

HDFC has a high base (+36.1% a year ago) and its swipes are up 17.7%. ICICI's base is lower (+8.8%), and its swipes are down 6.2%.



In a month, yearly growth: HDFC 0.9% to –6.7%, ICICI –5.1% to –9.2%.

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2 · AXIS BANK

The one big bank still moving

+15.7% and **+29.0%**

value at shops — swipes

That's on top of +46.5% a year ago. Its UPI QR codes also went from 13.05 to 19.37 crore in one month: a real push, or a reporting change?

BANK	VALUE	A YEAR AGO	SWIPES
All private	**1.4%**	**21.5%**	**21.6%**
Axis Bank	15.7%	46.5%	29.0%
HDFC Bank	−6.7%	36.1%	17.7%
ICICI Bank	−9.2%	8.8%	−6.2%

In a month, yearly value growth went from 11.6% to 15.7%.

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3 · THE CHALLENGERS

Small banks, fast growth, four different ways

Yes Bank kept its pace. Federal Bank is adding cards fastest. Kotak's jump comes off a weak year.

BANK	VALUE	A YEAR AGO	CARDS
All private	**1.4%**	**21.5%**	**9.6%**
Yes Bank	41.6%	42.0%	17.7%
Federal Bank	40.7%	22.5%	75.0%
Kotak	35.8%	−1.3%	7.3%
IDFC First	26.8%	13.6%	23.7%

In a month, all four eased a little: Yes 42.3% to 41.6%, Federal 44.4% to 40.7%, Kotak 39.4% to 35.8%, IDFC First 30.2% to 26.8%.

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4 · FALLING BEHIND

Two banks going the other way

−42.8% vs **+3.9%**

IndusInd — RBL Bank

Since Jan 2024, IndusInd's share went from 3.6% to 2.2%, RBL's from 5.8% to 3.2%. RBL's swipes are down 8.4%.

BANK	SHARE	VALUE	SWIPES	CARDS
All private	**72.7%**	**1.4%**	**21.6%**	**9.6%**
IndusInd	2.2%	−42.8%	−40.3%	−6.5%
RBL Bank	3.2%	3.9%	−8.4%	2.9%

In a month, yearly growth: IndusInd −47.7% to −42.8%, RBL 3.7% to 3.9%.

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THE TWIST · SHARE OF THE YEAR'S GROWTH

But the growth didn't go to private banks anyway

71.0% vs **14.7%**

public banks | private banks

SBI alone grew 25.2%, with swipes flat at −0.3%.

So who's actually winning cards in India?

If you work on cards at one of these banks, what am I missing?

In a month, public banks' share of the growth went from 51.0% to 71.0%.

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